

THE ARCHIVE OF MELQUÍADES

A Visual Chronicle of the Founding of Macondo



*Manuscript restored from the room
where it is always March.*

A PRICK OF CONSCIENCE

4



"Go home and get a weapon, because I'm going to kill you."

The Primal Sin:

José Arcadio Buendía and Úrsula Iguarán were cousins, bound by a fear of breeding "iguanas" (children with pig tails). Their marriage remained unconsummated for a year until a cockfight insult led to a duel of honor.



The Aftermath: The ghost of Prudencio Aguilar, washing his throat with an esparto grass plug, tormented them not with fear, but with loneliness.

“THE LAND NO ONE PROMISED” in IM Fell English SC

Riohacha
(The Past)

Pinyon Script

The Swamp
(The Obstacle)

Outcome:
They convinced themselves
they would never find the sea.
They cut down trees by the
stony river and stayed.

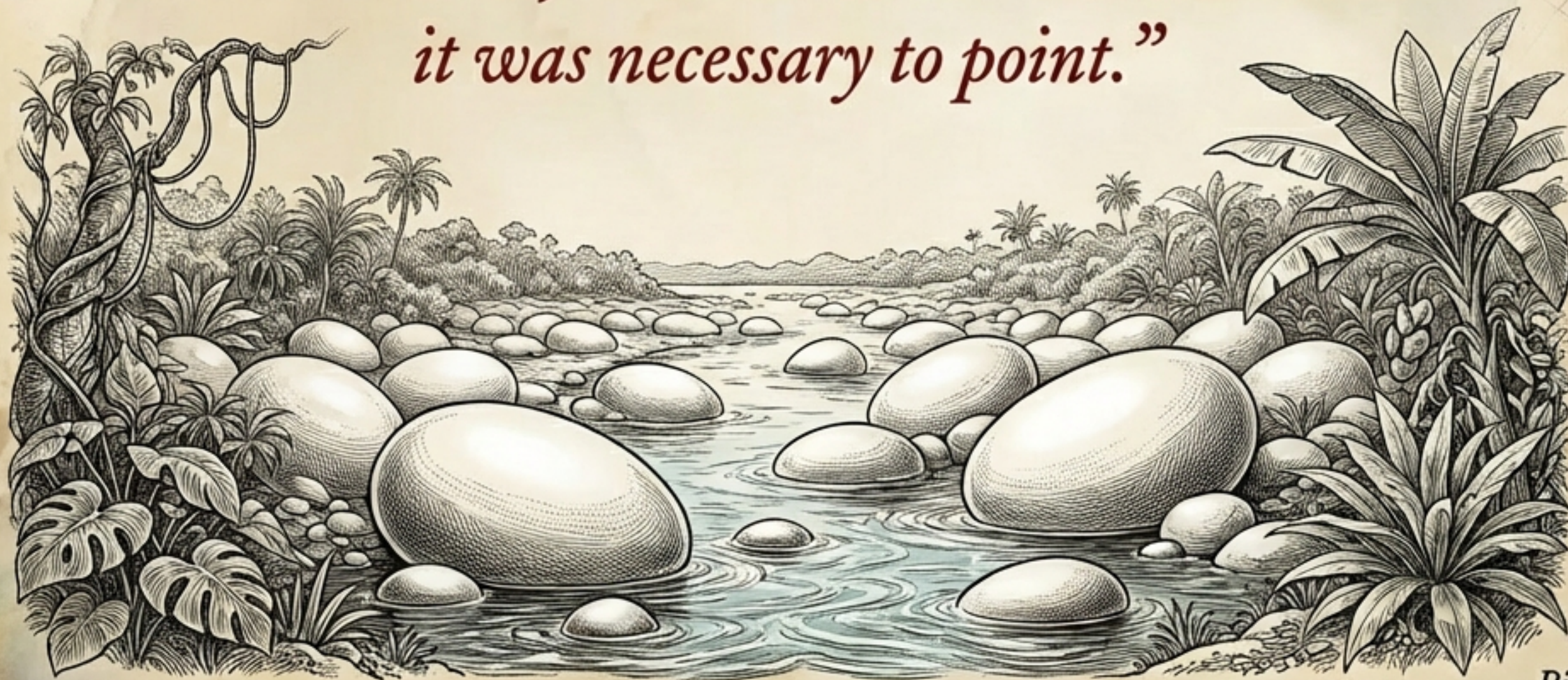


The Spanish Galleon

The Dream:
*J.A.B. dreamed of
a noisy city with
houses having
mirror walls.*

“THE WORLD WAS SO RECENT”

“The world was so recent that many things lacked names, and in order to indicate them it was necessary to point.”



Pinyon Script

A village of twenty adobe houses built on the bank of a river of clear water. The stones in the riverbed were white and enormous, like prehistoric eggs.

"THE EIGHTH WONDER OF THE ALCHEMISTS" in IM Fell English SC

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Raven Hat

Sparrow's Hands

Pinyon Script



The Magnet:

Melquiades dragging ingots; pots and pans tumbling from cupboards. *"Things have a life of their own; it's simply a matter of waking up their souls."*

The Magnifying Glass:

Solar warfare. José Arcadio Buendía suffers burns attempting to create a weapon.



The Relationship:

The bond between the 'honest' Melquiades and the obsessive José Arcadio Buendía.

"THE GREAT INVENTION OF OUR TIME" in IM Fell English SC

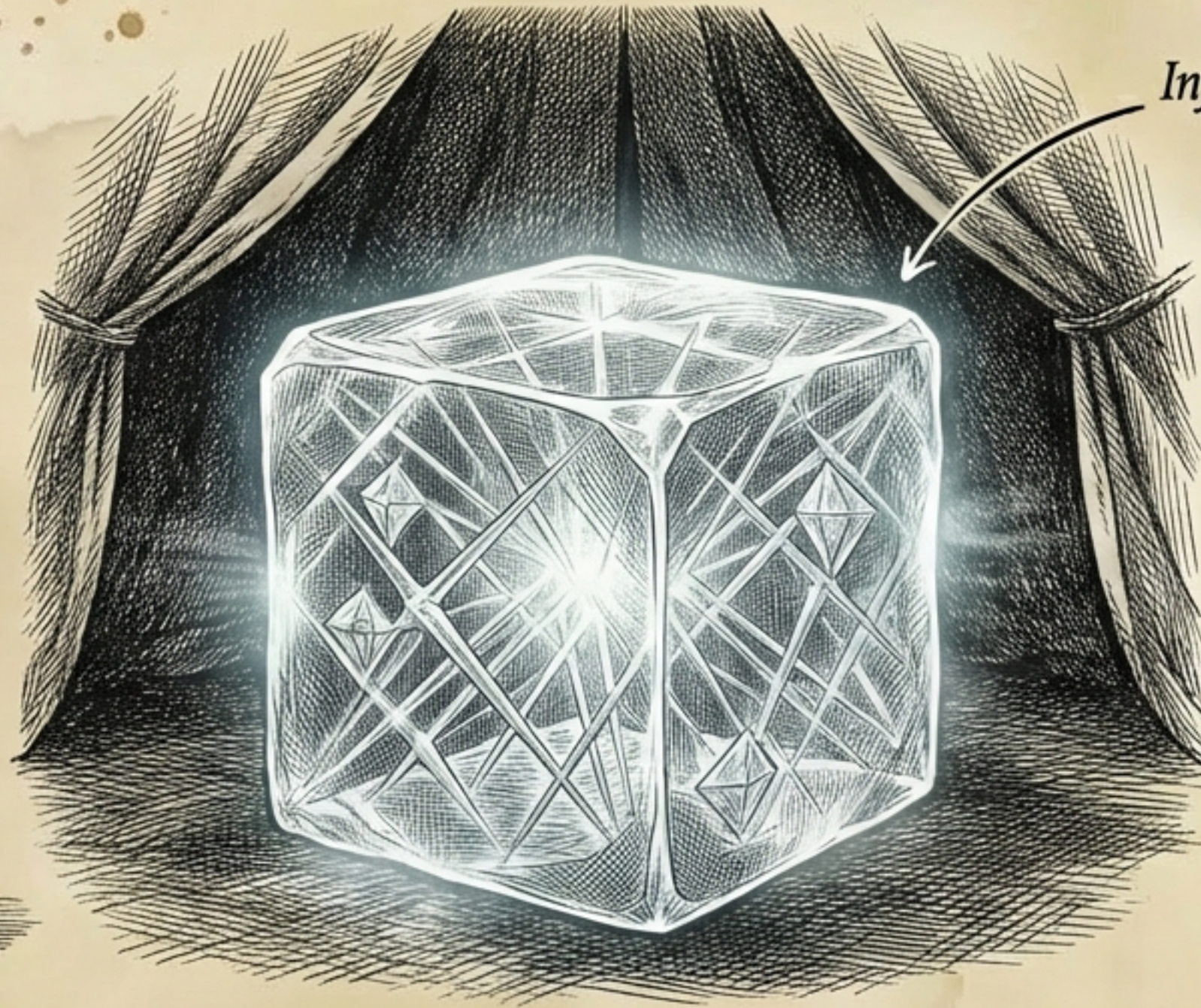
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The Scene:

A giant guarding a pirate chest. The payment of five reales to touch it.



A Giant Guarding



Infinite Internal Needles

José Arcadio Buendía:

"It is the largest diamond in the world."

Aureliano (Child):

"It's boiling."

Pinyon Script

Significance: This moment defines the Buendía obsession with the unknown, blurring the line between science and magic.

"THE ALCHEMY LAB" in IM Fell English SC

2

Pinyon Script

The Delusion

Materials: Mercury, vitriol of Cyprus, hog fat.

Goal: The Philosopher's Stone / Doubling gold.

Result: A pestilential syrup.

Pinyon Script

Pinyon Script

The Reality

Source: Úrsula's colonial gold coins (her inheritance).

Outcome: Reduced to a large piece of burnt hog cracklings stuck to the pot.

Pinyon Script

Insight: Ursula works the earth; J.A.B. works the stars.



"THE LINEAGE (GENERATION 2" in IM Fell English SC

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José Arcadio Buendía + Úrsula Iguarán

Ship/Gun
Icon



Ship/Gun
Icon

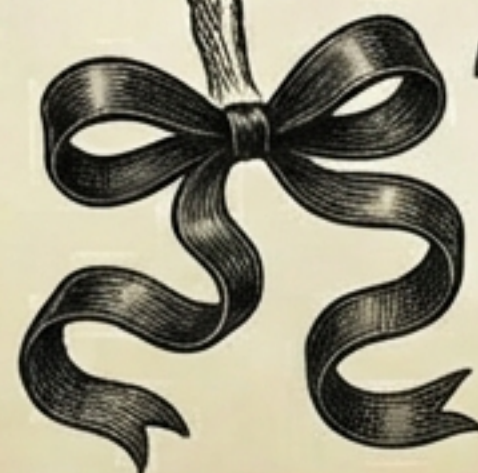
José Arcadio
(The Elder Son)
Monumental size,
impulsive.

Golden
Fish Icon



Aureliano
(The Second Son)
Silent, withdrawn,
clairvoyant.

Black
Ribbon
Icon



Amaranta
The daughter.

Black Ribbon
Icon

Sack
Icon



Rebeca

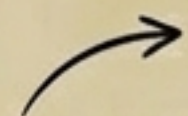
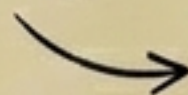
The orphan relative /
The Outsider.

"THE ELDEST SON" in IM Fell English SC

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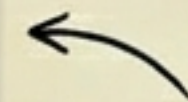
The Catalyst:

Pilar Ternera.
A woman who smells
of smoke. She initiates
him into manhood in
the granary.



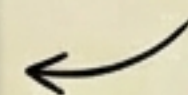
The Result:

She becomes pregnant.



The Flight:

José Arcadio runs away
with a gypsy troupe,
captivated by
a gypsy girl.



"May God preserve you just as you are." — The gypsy woman admiring his physique.

— *Pinyon Script*

"THE CLAIRVOYANT SILVERSMITH" in IM Fell English SC

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"Born with
eyes open."

"Predicted:

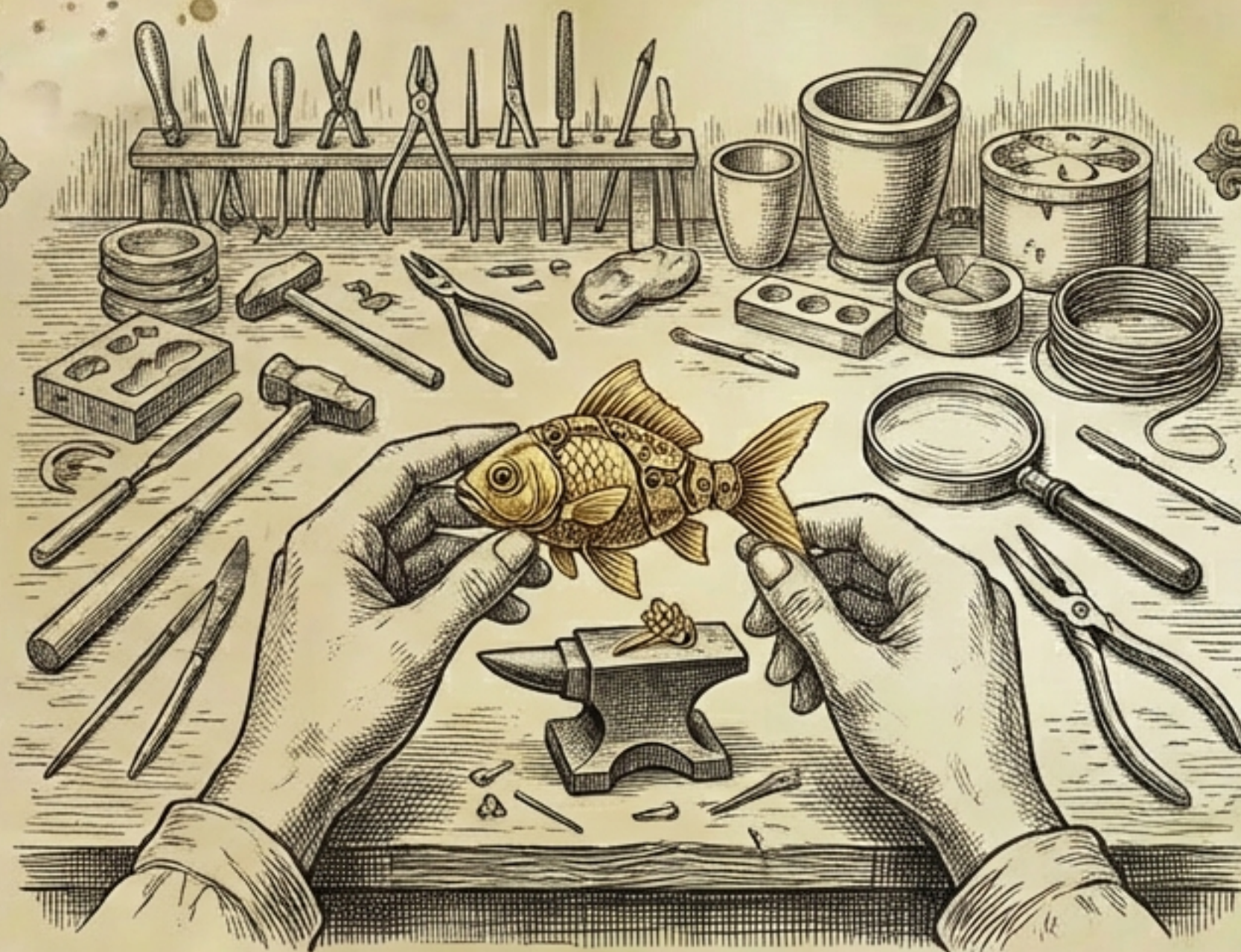
"Predicted the pot
of soup falling:
'It's going to spill.'"

"Alchemical aptitude:

'Strange intuition
for alchemy.'"

"Solitary:

Resigned to being
a 'womanless man.'"



While his brother explores the physical world, Aureliano
explores the internal and metallurgical world.

— Pinyon Script

"THE ORPHAN AND THE CLATTER OF BONES" in IM Fell English SC

The Letter

Unrecognizable names,
claiming relation
to Úrsula.

The Sack:

Contains her parents'
bones; makes a
"cloc-cloc-cloc" sound.



The Vices

Eating damp earth from
the courtyard and cake of
whitewash from the walls.

Treatment:

Úrsula treats the
earth-eating with ox
gall and rhubarb.

"THE PLAGUE OF FORGETFULNESS" in IM Fell English SC

Origin: Brought by **Rebeca**; identified by the Indian servant **Visitación** (a princess in exile from the plague).

Pinyon Script



The Contagion: Spread through mouth/food. Úrsula's candy animals (little green roosters, pink fish) infect the whole town.

Pinyon Script

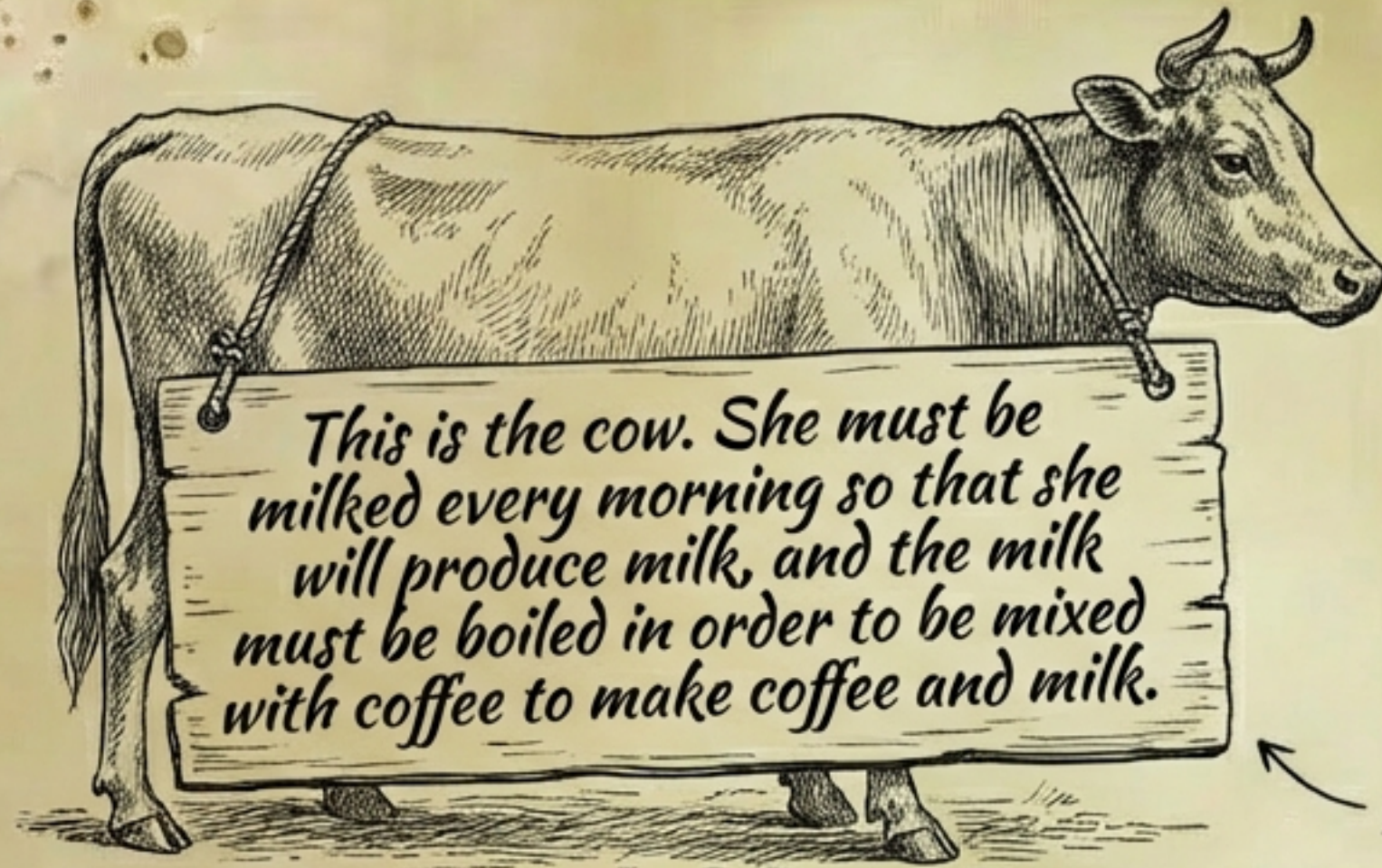
Symptoms:

1. Complete loss of sleep (body feels no fatigue).
2. Dreaming while awake (hallucinations).
3. **Critical Phase:** The erasure of memory. Loss of the name and notion of things.



— *Pinyon Script*

“CAPTURING REALITY WITH WORDS” in IM Fell English SC



*This is the cow. She must be
milked every morning so that she
will produce milk, and the milk
must be boiled in order to be mixed
with coffee to make coffee and milk.*

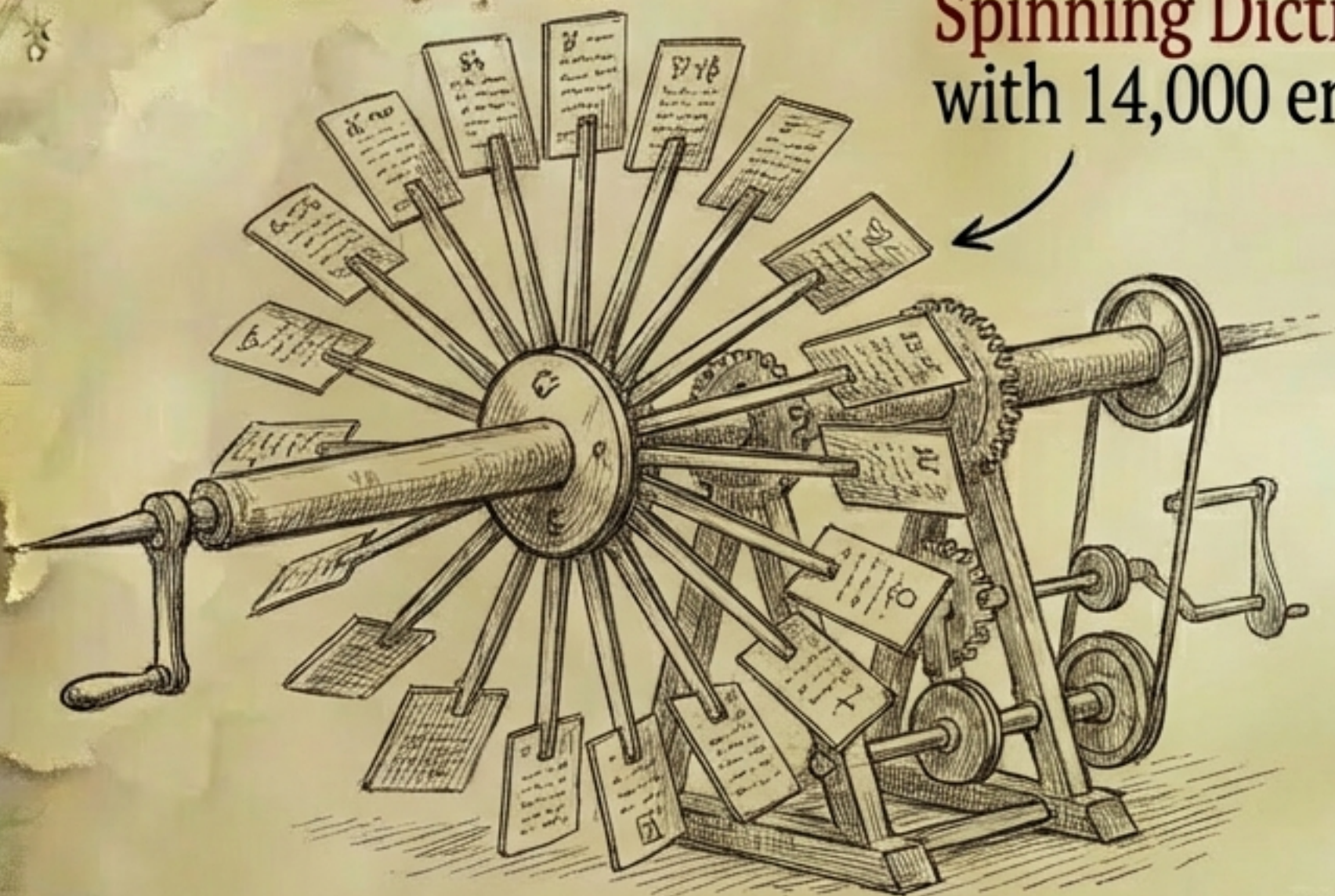
Pinyon Script

Context: Aureliano's method.
They labeled everything: Table,
Chair, Clock, Door, God Exists.

The Futility: “They would escape
irremediably when they forgot
the values of the written letters.”

"THE MEMORY MACHINE" in IM Fell English SC

Spinning Dictionary
with 14,000 entries.



Function: To review the totality of knowledge every morning.

Pinyon
Script

Alternative Coping: Pilar Ternera uses tarot cards to "read the past" since no one can remember it. (e.g., A father is remembered as "the dark man").



“THE ANTIDOTE” in IM Fell English SC

Pinyon Script

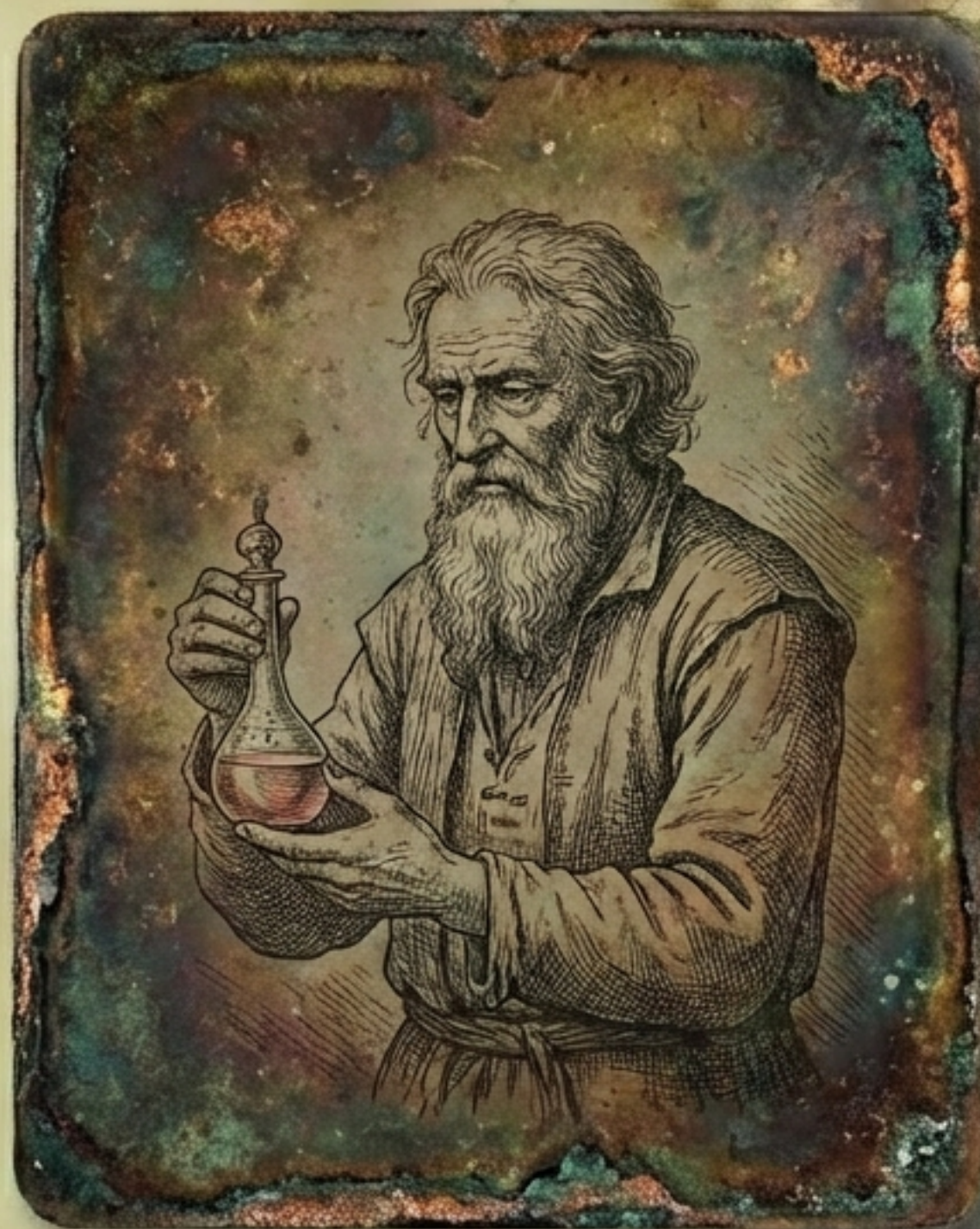
The Return: Melquíades returns from death because he “could not bear the solitude.”

The Cure: A gentle-colored drink that restores the light of memory immediately.

Pinyon Script

Legacy: He stays to open a Daguerreotype laboratory.

“Melquíades”
in Pinyon Script



"THE OXIDIZED DAGUERRETYPE"

Theme: The attempt to preserve the moment scientifically.

J.A.B.'s New Obsession: Using the camera to obtain scientific proof of the existence of God (taking photos of empty rooms).

Pinyon Script

"If you don't fear God, fear him through the metals."

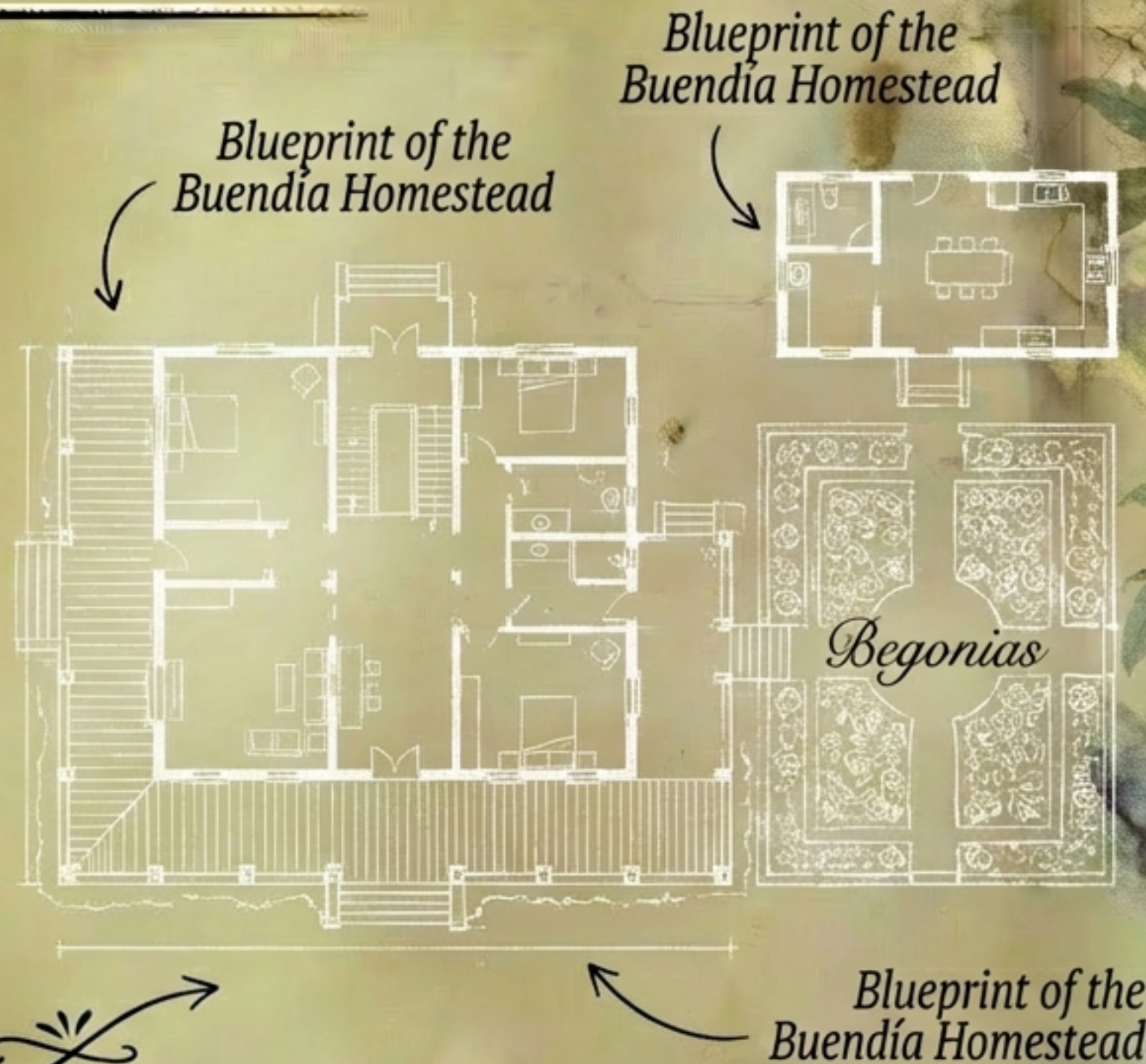


"WHITE AS A DOVE"

The Renovation:
Driven by Úrsula's candy business wealth.

Purpose:
To provide a worthy setting for Rebeca and Amaranta (now adolescents).

Key Detail:
The house is painted white, symbolizing the Buendía autonomy.



Blueprint of the Buendía Homestead

Blueprint of the Buendía Homestead

Begonias

Blueprint of the Buendía Homestead

"THE MAGISTRATE & THE PAINT" in IM Fell English SC



Pinyon Script:
"The Magistrate's
Decree"

Pinyon Script:
"J.A.B.'s
Defiance"



The Conflict: Don Apolinar Moscote (The Magistrate) orders all houses painted blue for Independence Day.
(in IM Fell English SC.).

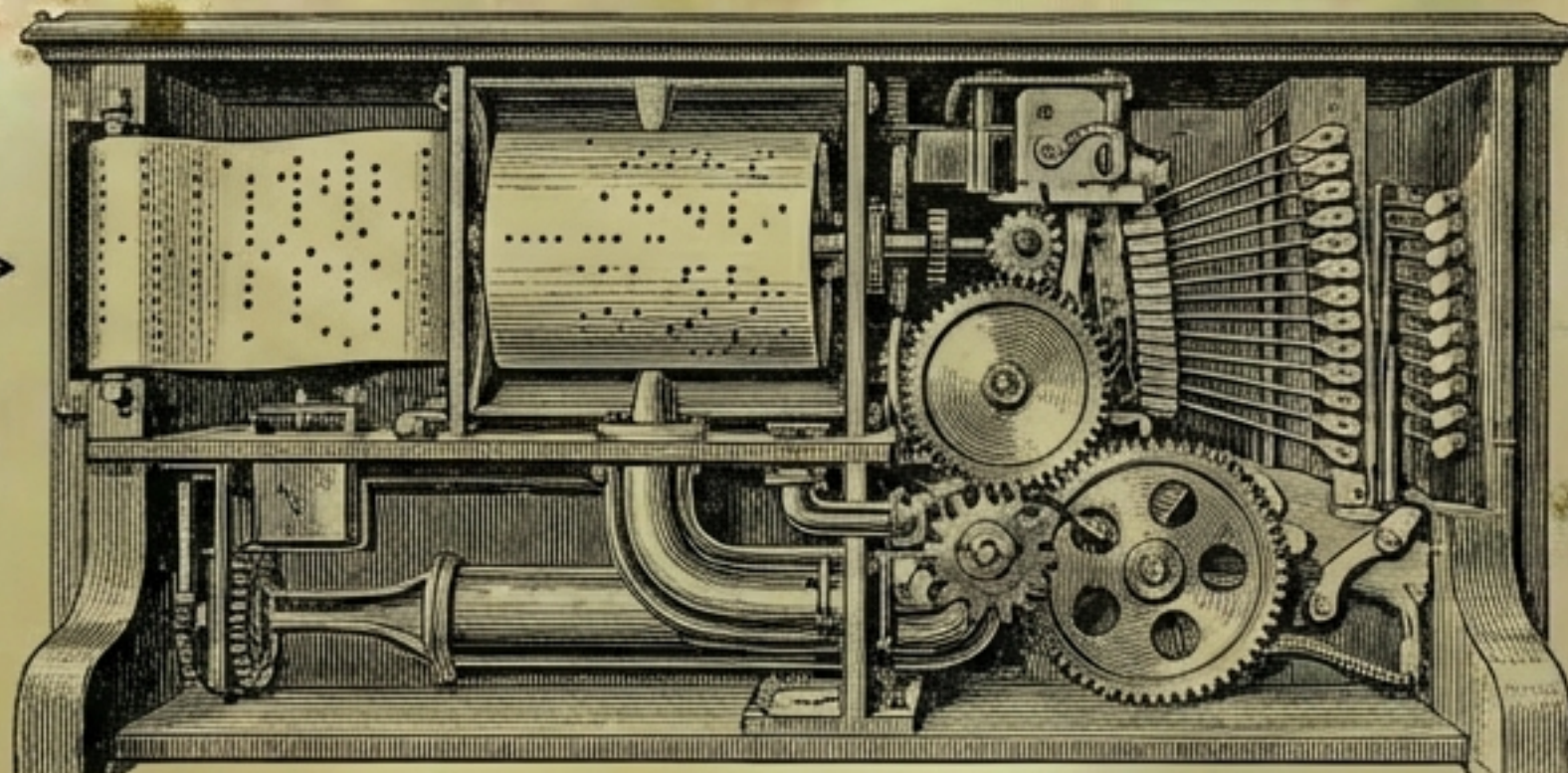
The Response: J.A.B. refuses. "My house is going to be white, like a dove."

The Resolution: J.A.B. physically carries the Magistrate out of town, but allows him to return if the soldiers leave and the house stays white.

Insight: The loss of innocence; Macondo is now a town with authority figures.

"THE HUMAN ANGEL" in IM Fell English SC

*The Pianola's
Music Rolls*



*Mechanical
Marvel*

The Character: Pietro Crespi. Italian, blond, "angelic." Came to assemble the pianola.

The Scene: Teaching Rebeca and Amaranta to dance.

Visual Detail: Pietro Crespi's "elastic and tight" pants.

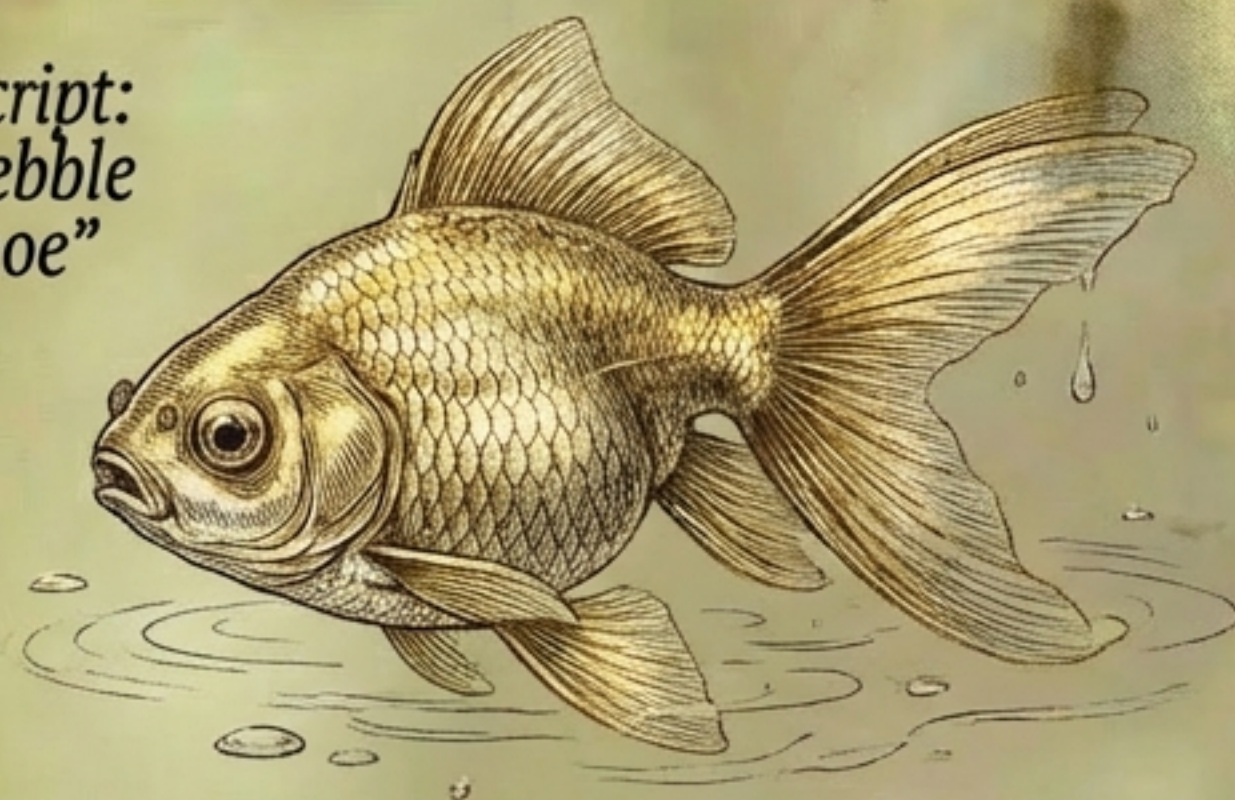
*Pinyon Script:
Symbol of Modernity
& Allure*

Impact: The house becomes a center of social life; the isolation is broken.

"THE PEBBLE IN THE SHOE" in IM Fell English SC



Pinyon Script:
*"Like a pebble
in his shoe"*



The Obsession: Aureliano falls for Remedios Moscote (the Magistrate's child daughter).

The Feeling: A physical sensation, "like a pebble in his shoe."

The Action: He writes poetry on parchments, walls, and his own skin.

Closing Note: The man who studied metals and ice is finally conquered by a human emotion.

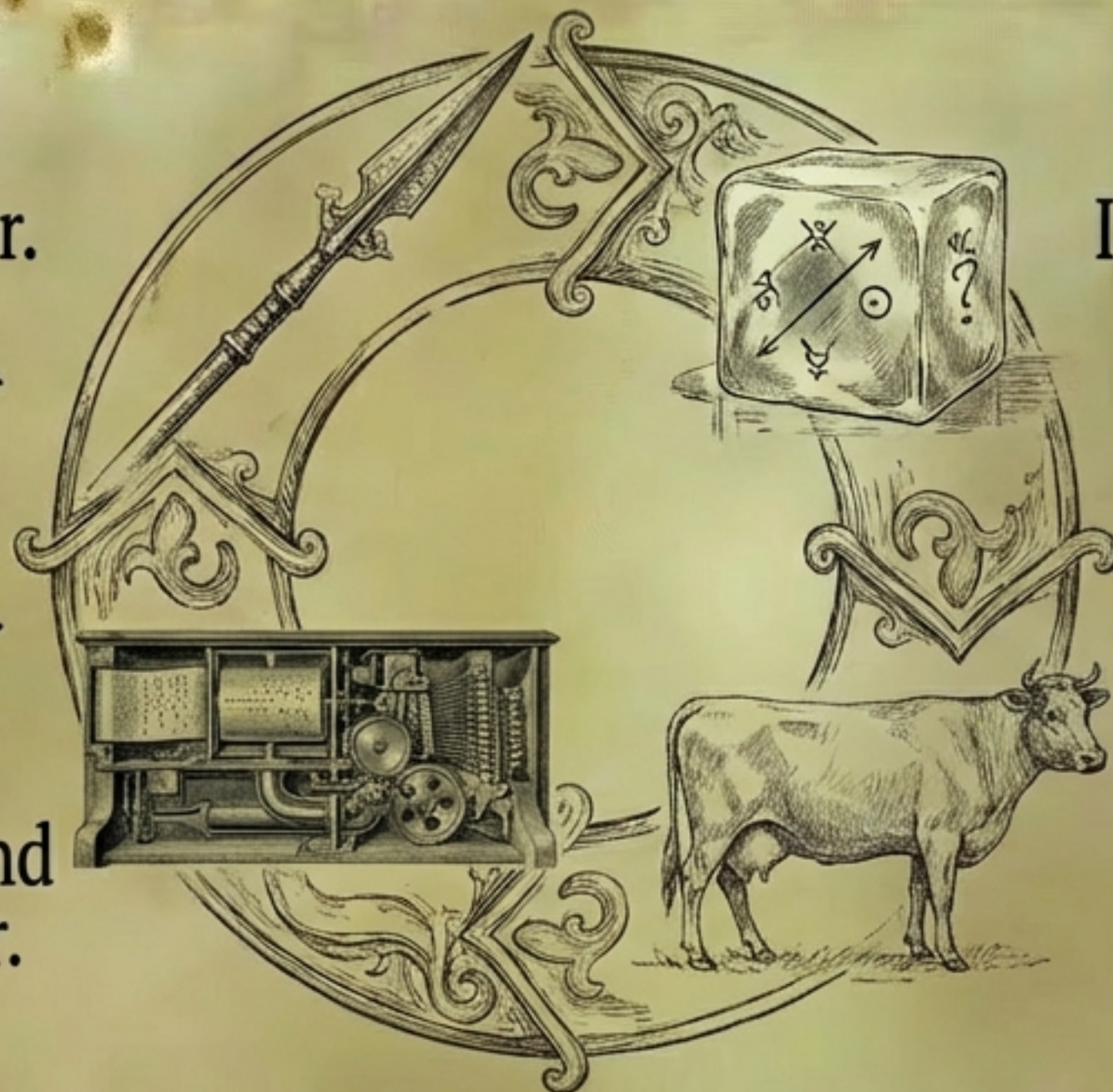
"THE WHEEL OF TIME" in IM Fell English SC

Genesis:
A duel of honor.

Magic:
Ice and Alchemy.

Society: The
White House and
the Blue Order.

Crisis:
The Plague of
Insomnia.



It was not a linear progression, but a circle. The history of the family was a machine with unavoidable repetitions.